

3rd Southeast Asia Economic Research and Development Conference

30-31 October, 2025
Siem Reap, Cambodia

#SAERD25



Venue: Paññāsāstra University of Cambodia, Siem Reap (PUCSR), Siem Reap, Cambodia

Website: <https://saerdconf.github.io>



Economics must serve humanity. We envision an economic thinking that transcends intellectual barriers, reflects reality, and advances the well-being of our global society.

Contact during the conference

Kosal Nith
Phone: +855 (0)12 340 226
Email: saerdconf@gmail.com

Organising committee

Kosal Nith
Young Scholars Initiative and CDRI

Sattwick Dey Biswas
Young Scholars Initiative

Sovannroeun Samreth
Saitama University

Sokhimmarya Chea
Royal University of Law and Economics

Jakkrya Sey
Cambodia Development Resource Institute

Sreymeng Sros
Royal University of Law and Economics

Sinoun Him
Ministry of Post and Telecommunications

Kean Muny Nhim
Cambodia Development Resource Institute



CONFERENCE OVERVIEW

THURSDAY, 30 OCTOBER 2025

10:20 – 12:00 Keynote Lecture

13:00 – 15:00 Parallel Sessions A

Monetary and Industrial Policy	Social Well-being	Labor and Gender Economics	Food Security and Rural Development	Small Business and Productivity
A1 Siem Reap	A2 Angkor Wat	A3 Angkor Thom	A4 Bayon	A5 Bakong

15:30 – 17:00 Panel Discussion A

FRIDAY, 31 OCTOBER 2025

08:40 – 10:00 Panel Discussion B

10:15 – 12:15 Parallel Sessions B

Agricultural Economics	Economic Inequality	Human Capital	Green Economics	Trade and Political Economy
B1 Siem Reap	B2 Angkor Wat	B3 Angkor Thom	B4 Bayon	B5 Bakong

13:00 – 15:00 Parallel Sessions C

Health Economics	Gender Economics	Economic Policy	Environmental Economics
C1 Siem Reap	C2 Angkor Wat	C3 Angkor Thom	C4 Bayon

15:15 – 15:45 Asia Developing Region Book Project

Media and Recording Notice

Photos may be taken and film and sound recordings made during the conference for documentation and public relations purposes. These may be published on the Internet, on social media, and in other media for further use. By attending the conference, participants agree to such use of recordings and images without claim to remuneration. If participants do not wish to be photographed or recorded, they are kindly requested to inform the organizer in advance.

THURSDAY, 30 OCTOBER 2025

3RD SOUTHEAST ASIA ECONOMIC RESEARCH AND DEVELOPMENT CONFERENCE

Siem Reap Hall

08:30 – 09:00 **Registration**

09:00 – 09:05 **National anthem**

09:05 – 09:15 **Welcome remark**

*Dr. Sattwick Dey Biswas, History of Economic Thought
Working Group Coordinator, Young Scholar Initiative*

*Mr. Kosal Nith, East Asia Working Group Coordinator,
Young Scholars Initiative*

09:15 – 09:45 **Keynote remark**

*Dr. Chea San Chanthan, Chairman and Chancellor,
Paññāsāstra University of Cambodia, Siem Reap
Campus, Cambodia*

*Mr. Shakeel Ahmad, Deputy Resident Representative,
UNDP Cambodia*

09:45 – 10:00

Introduction to the Young Scholars Initiative

*Mr. Kosal Nith, East Asia Working Group Coordinator,
Young Scholars Initiative*

10:00 – 10:20 **Coffee break**

10:20 – 12:00 **KEYNOTE LECTURE**

*Moderator: Prof. Sovannroeun Samreth, Professor of
Economics Saitama University, Japan*

**A Global Measure of Inequality: Household Disparities,
Child Poverty, and Gender Gaps in Consumption**

*Prof. Olivier Bargain, Professor of Economics,
Bordeaux University, France*

**Global Multilateralism and Protectionism: Implications
for Human Development and the HDI**

*Mr. Shakeel Ahmad, Deputy Resident Representative,
UNDP Cambodia*

12:00 – 13:00 Lunch

13:00 – 15:00 PARALLEL SESSIONS A

15:00 – 15:30 Coffee break

15:30 – 17:00 PANEL DISCUSSION A

Moderator: Dr. Sattwick Dey Biswas, Young Scholars Initiative

**Green Economics and Social Development:
Opportunities and Challenges**

Prof. Phanith Chou, Associate Professor of Environmental Economics, Royal University of Phnom Penh, Cambodia

Mr. Theara Khoun, Socio-economic Policy Specialist, UNDP Cambodia, Cambodia

Dr. Daniel Yonto, Assistant Professor, Xi'an Jiaotong-Liverpool University, China

19:00 – 21.00 Networking dinner

Hotel Somadevi Angkor Resort & Spa

FRIDAY, 31 OCTOBER 2025

3RD SOUTHEAST ASIA ECONOMIC RESEARCH AND DEVELOPMENT CONFERENCE

Siem Reap Hall

08:40 – 10:00

PANEL DISCUSSION B

*Moderator: Asso. Prof. Penghuy Ngov,
Royal University of Phnom Penh*

Economic Development and the Role of Human Capital

*Prof. Sovannroeun Samreth, Professor of Economics,
Saitama University, Japan*

*Dr. Ratha Chiv, Executive Vice Chancellor,
Paññāsāstra University of Cambodia, Siem Reap
Campus, Cambodia*

Dr. Rada Khoy, Economist, UNDP Cambodia, Cambodia

*Dr. Maria C. Lo Bue, Assistant Professor,
University of Trieste, Italy*

10:00 – 10:15

Coffee break

10:15 – 12:15

PARALLEL SESSIONS B

12:15 – 13:00

Lunch

13:00 – 15:00

PARALLEL SESSIONS C

15:00 – 15:15

Coffee break

15:15 – 15:45

Asia Developing Region Book

*Dr. Sattwick Dey Biswas, History of Economic Thought
Working Group Coordinator, Young Scholar Initiative*

*Prof. Sovannroeun Samreth, Professor of Economics,
Saitama University, Japan*

15:45 – 16:00

Closing remarking

The Conference Organizing Committee

19:00 – 21:00

Dinner

Hotel Somadevi Angkor Resort & Spa

MONETARY AND INDUSTRIAL POLICY
Chair: Asso. Prof. Penghuy Ngov, RUPP

Tokenising People's Monetary Circuit and the Quiet, Infrastructural Redirection of Macroeconomics – Hints from Cambodia's Bakong
Hizkia Yosias Polimpung (Monash University Malaysia)

Cambodian Monetary Sovereignty Under Pressure: The Triple Challenge of Dollarization, Yuan Expansion, and Cryptoization
Clement Berthou (Université Grenoble Alpes/Institute for Banking Studies)

The Impact of Technological Changes on Income Distribution of Fisher Households in Malabar Region of Kerala, India
Ubaish Mon C.P. (University of Calicut) and Nirmala Velan (GITAM University)

From Industrial Policy to Digital Ambitions: Tracing the Evolution of Indonesia's Economic Development Through the Rise of Its Digital Economy
Jun Shen (Nanyang Technological University)

LABOR AND GENDER ECONOMICS
Chair: Prof. Olivier Bargain, Bordeaux University

Promoting Economic Empowerment of Cambodian Women Workers through Knowledge-Centred Interventions
Deeksha Gulati (Solidar Suisse)

Nexus of Gender and Caste: Occupational Segregation in Indian Megacities
Jyoti Thakur (National Council of Applied Economic Research)

Recruitment Mechanisms and Employment Practices in the Construction Industry in Assam: Socioeconomic Evidence from a Field Survey
Dhritiraj Sarma (Cotton University)

Affirmative Action in India: Impacts on Assortative Matching, Fertility, and Women's Labor Participation
Pragati Pragati (Indian Institute of Technology)

SMALL BUSINESS AND PRODUCTIVITY
Chair: Dr. Chanthol Hay, Pannasastra University

Factors Affecting Productivity and Barriers to Formality of SMEs in Cambodia: Evidence from the Economic Census 2022 and fDi Market Data
Chanthol Hay (Pannasastra University)

Can Cambodia Catch-up with Technological Frontier Economies? Analysis of Innovation and Productivity at the Firm Level
Thach Bunroeun (National University of Battambang)

The Role of Local and Foreign Platforms in Shaping SME Development through Digital Trade in Cambodia
Kean Muny Nhim (CDRI)

Foreign Patenting and Middle Income Economies: Global and Firm-level Perspectives
Pieter Stek (Asia School of Business)

SOCIAL WELL-BEING I
Chair: Dr. Rada Khoy, UNDP Cambodia

Expanding Social Protection to the Informal Sector in Thailand: Key Drivers and Limitations
Darlin Nay (Agricultural and Rural Development Bank)

Assessing the Effectiveness of Cambodia's National Social Protection Policy Framework in Safeguarding the Informal Sector's Income-Generation Capacity
Vimuoela Hang (King's College London)

Navigating the Blue Waters: Relational Power and the Construction of ASEAN Centrality in Regional Maritime Economy Cooperation
Lingyan Zhu (Universiti Malaya)

Gender Analysis in the Fishery Sector and the Impact of State Policies on Sustainable Livelihoods: A Case Study of Giao Thuy District, Nam Dinh Province
Thu Ha Thi Pham (Vietnam National University of Agriculture)

FOOD SECURITY AND RURAL DEVELOPMENT
Chair: Prof. Phanith Chou, Royal University of Phnom Penh

Exploring the Effects of Remittance on Dietary Diversity and Food Security: Evidence from HIES 2022
Mahjabin Rashid Lamisha (University of Dhaka)

How Does Crop Insurance Affect Food Security? An Endogenous Switching Regression Analysis from Central India
Ashish Chouhan (Indian Institute of Technology Guwahati)

Patterns and Determinants of Dietary Security among Tea Garden Workers: A Case Study of Jalpaiguri District, India
Saddam Hossain Mondal (Heramba Chandra College)

Occupational Changes and Human Capital Investment Following Rural Road Rehabilitation: Evidence from Cambodia
Sei Okamoto (Independent Researcher)

FRIDAY, 31 OCTOBER 2025

PARALLEL SESSIONS B 10:15 - 12:15

SiemReap B1	AGRICULTURAL ECONOMICS <i>Chair: Prof. Sovannroeun Samreth, Saitama University</i> Assessing the Adoption of Low-Carbon Rice Cultivation in Selected ASEAN Countries: Implications for Cambodia <i>Monineath Horn (Agriculture and Rural Development Bank, ARDB)</i> The Role of Development Finance Institutions in Supporting Agricultural Cooperatives in Cambodia: A Study on the Agricultural and Rural Development Bank <i>Hang Panha Hour (ARDB)</i> MSMEs Development in Cambodia: An Institutional Analysis through the Lens of the Developmental State <i>Darlin Nay (ARDB)</i> The Analysis of Agri-food Processing SMEs in Cambodia <i>Panha Pich Sok (ARDB)</i>	AngkorWat B2	ECONOMIC INEQUALITY <i>Chair: Dr. Sushil Goswami, Gujarat National Law University</i> Asymmetric Influence of Economic Growth on Income Inequality: Evidence from West Africa <i>Bernard-Didier Benissan (University of Abomey-Calavi)</i> Spatial Dynamics of Regional Inequality and Fiscal Policy in India: 1991–2023 <i>Vinay Kumar (Indian Institute of Technology Bhilai)</i> Malaysia's Declining Innovation Output - Regional and Triple Helix Perspectives <i>Rasyid Juhari (Asia School of Business)</i> Climate Resilience, Economic Inequality and Inclusive Development in Southeast Asia's Coastal Communities <i>Sushil Goswami (Gujarat National Law University)</i>
	HUMAN CAPITAL <i>Chair: Mr. Theara Khoun, UNDP Cambodia</i> The Impact of Educational Opportunities on the Academic And Non-Academic Achievement of Indian Students in Selangor, Malaysia <i>Sivam Tamilaseluan (Universiti Malaya)</i> Examining Cambodian Upper Secondary School Students' Perceptions of TVET as a Career Choice: A Cross-Sectional Study <i>Vitou Tes (Teacher Development Support Organization)</i> From Budget to Benefits: Effects of Gender Budgeting on School Infrastructure and Girls' Education in India <i>Prakashani Singh (Indian Institute of Technology Kanpur)</i> Human Labour Behind Artificial Intelligence: Is Micro-Tasking Perpetuating Coloniality in the Global South (and Southeast Asia)? <i>Giulio Pavesi (University of Amsterdam)</i>		GREEN ECONOMICS <i>Chair: Prof. Keiji Ujikawa, Yokohama National University</i> Balancing Growth and Environmental Resilience: Asymmetric Effects of FDI and Economic Development on Emissions in Central Asia <i>Sana Saleem (University of Brunei Darussalam)</i> Strengthening Indonesia's Jetp: Optimising Clean Energy Finance And Investment To Achieve Net-Zero Emissions <i>Ahmad Sabirin (Institute for Climate Law and Sustainable Policy)</i> Nuclear Energy Renaissance and Domestic Institutional Support: Examining Japan's Policy Capacity <i>Mohid Iftikhar (Lingnan University)</i> Macroeconomic Challenges and Opportunities for Planning the Green Transition in Cambodia <i>Isabelle Ferraudo (Université Grenoble Alpes)</i>
	TRADE AND POLITICAL ECONOMY <i>Chair: Dr. Pranita Pathak, Savitribai Phule Pune University</i> Trade and Institutional Change: A Historical Analysis of Colonial Expansion in Burma and Siam, 1852-1900 <i>Mek Ajay Sribhibhadh (LSE)</i> State Power and Market Harm: Competition Law, Economic Welfare, and the Case for an ASEAN Competitive Neutrality Agreement <i>Jimi Rambo Arranchado (University of Canterbury)</i> Unequal Exchange in the ASEAN Region: Revisiting Arghiri Emmanuel's Theory in the Context of Global Value Chains <i>Pranita Pathak (Savitribai Phule Pune University)</i> Malaysia's EV Landscape: A Critical Look at Current Policies, Progress, and Gaps in The National EV Ecosystem <i>Thirunaukarasu Subramaniam (Universiti Malaya)</i>		
AngkorThom B3		Bayon B4	
Bakong B5			

FRIDAY, 31 OCTOBER 2025

PARALLEL SESSIONS C 13:00 - 15:00

C1	SieamReap	HEALTH ECONOMICS <i>Chair: Asso. Prof. Thirunaukarasu Subramaniam, Universiti Malaya</i> Navigating Online Health Information in the Digital Age: Evidence on NCD Management from Kerala's Digital Health Landscape <i>Swathi Krishna K U (Centre for Development Studies)</i> Food Security and Agrarian Transformation <i>Trey Silong (Royal University of Phnom Penh)</i> The Role of Health Financing System and Pluralism in Achieving SDG Health Outcomes in India: A Multilevel Analysis <i>Pragyan Monalisa Sahoo (Utkal University)</i> Determinants of Suicide Mortality in Southeast Asia <i>Thirunaukarasu Subramaniam (Universiti Malaya)</i>
		GENDER ECONOMICS <i>Chair: Dr. Maria C. Lo Bue, University of Trieste</i> Corporate Diversity, Equity and Inclusion (DEI) in Multiethnic Societies: Identifying Broad-Based and Gender-Focused Paradigms <i>Triny Lum (Asia School of Business)</i> Strengthening Women's Economic Security and Sustainable Agricultural Practices: Insights from the AGROW Project <i>Sokmoly Uon and Pirom Khiev (Cambodia Development Resource Institute)</i> The Role of Women in the 1998 Election: A Case Study of Conflict Between Bisaya and Kolibugan Tribes in Sirawai <i>Fahadz Lulu (Philippine Women's University)</i>
		ECONOMIC POLICY <i>Chair: Mr. Kosal Nith, Cambodia Development Resource Institute and YSI</i> Investment and Growth Nexus in Indonesia: Insights into Regional Macroeconomic Stability in a Resource-Rich Economy <i>Yesi Hendriani Supartoyo (National Research and Innovation Agency)</i> Accelerating Digitalization and Technological Innovation as Keys to Boosting Economic Growth in Asia <i>Ndirangu Ngunjiri (University of Nairobi)</i> Divergence and Convergence: A Comparative Analysis of FDI Deliveries in Southeast Asia <i>Roop Chand Hindu (Universiti Malaya)</i> Fiscal Policy and Public Investment in Cambodia <i>Kosal Nith (Cambodia Development Resource Institute and YSI)</i>
C2	AngkorWat	
C3	AngkorThom	
C4	Bayon	ENVIRONMENTAL ECONOMICS <i>Chair: Dr. Raksme Ang, Cambodia Development Resource Institute</i> Revisiting the Disaster-Growth Nexus: Panel Data Evidence from Southeast Asian Countries <i>Abina VP (Institute for Social and Economic Change)</i> Myitsone Dam's Environmental Impact on Vulnerable Community Resilience in Myanmar after 2021 Coup <i>Aung Than Oo (Tsinghua University/Rotary Peace Center of Makerere University)</i> Exploring the Determinants of CO2 Emissions in Asian Countries: Assessing the Existence of the Environmental Kuznets Curve <i>Puja Biswas (Prasanta Chandra Mahalanobis Mahavidyalaya)</i> Strengthening Systems for Inclusive Climate Resilient Water, Sanitation and Hygiene Services in Cambodia <i>Raksme Ang (Cambodia Development Resource Institute)</i>

SPEAKERS' BIOS



Mr. Shakeel Ahmad is a development economist with over 22 years of experience in international development, including 16 years with UNDP at regional and country levels. He holds a master's degree in Development Management from the London School of Economics and Political Science and a master's in Agricultural Economics (Gold Medal) from The University of Agriculture, Peshawar, Pakistan. Before his current role as Deputy Resident Representative, he served as Country Programme Specialist at the UNDP Bangkok Regional Hub, providing programme oversight and support to UNDP offices across Asia and the Pacific. He also worked with UNDP Afghanistan as Policy Advisor and led UNDP's SURGE mission in response to the 2022 floods in Pakistan. Earlier, he headed the Development Policy Unit at UNDP Pakistan, supporting SDG implementation at national and provincial levels. Prior to joining UNDP, Shakeel worked with the Swiss Agency for Development and Cooperation and local NGOs.



Olivier Bargain is a Professor of Economics at the University of Bordeaux, and previously at Aix Marseille University (2011-17), at University College Dublin (2006-11), and at the Institute for the Study of Labor (IZA, Bonn, 2004-06). He is a research fellow at different institutions (IZA, LISER, UNU-WIDER). Graduated from ESCP and a PhD at the Paris School of Economics (EHESS, ENS, CNRS), he works on various topics in public economics, labor, development & well-being. He is a former (co)editor of the book series Research in Labor Economics (Emerald) and a former associate editor of the Journal of Economic Inequality. He has conducted various consulting and advisory studies in France, Ireland, Germany, Poland, Chile, and for international organizations (World Bank, European Commission, OECD). He is a member of the Institut Universitaire de France and former member of the Council of Economic Advisors to the French PM.

SPEAKERS' BIOS



Phanith Chou is an environmental economist. He is an Associate Professor at the Royal University of Phnom Penh. Phanith earned his PhD in International Development from the Nagoya University (Japan). He has an extensive professional background and has conducted research on the economic assessment of nature-based solutions, environmental impact assessment, cost-benefit analysis, and sustainable food systems for over 15 years. Additionally, he has provided training, policy recommendations, and project implementation. He has collaborated with the private sector, government and international development agencies.



Daniel Yonto is an Assistant Professor of Urban Planning and Design at Xi'an Jiaotong-Liverpool University. His research explores the intersections of sustainable development, climate change education, and urbanization, with a strong focus on Southeast Asia. Dr. Yonto has led workshops on localizing climate education in Cambodia and his current work examines the socio-economic impacts of Special Economic Zones. As a panelist, he brings perspectives on integrating community knowledge and equitable strategies into green economic planning for socially just development.



Khoun Theara is a Policy Specialist at UNDP Cambodia, focusing on social protection, labor policy, poverty reduction, and SDG localization. He leads strategic policy research and program design, fostering partnerships across government, academia, and civil society. Theara holds a Master's in Public Policy (Economic Policy) from ANU and is pursuing a Satellite PhD in Development Economics at Nagoya University. His prior roles include Programme Manager at Future Forum, Senior Research Officer at BBC Media Action, and Political Research Officer at the Australian Embassy. He also worked as a journalist for Voice of America Khmer Service.

SPEAKERS' BIOS



Sovannroeun Samreth is a Professor at the Graduate School of Humanities and Social Sciences, Saitama University, Japan. In 2009, he received his Ph.D. in economics from the Graduate School of Economics, Kyoto University, Japan. He began his career as a Research Fellow at the Graduate School of Economics, Osaka University, Japan, and later as a Postdoctoral Research Fellow at the Graduate School of Economics, Kyoto University, under the program of the Japan Society for the Promotion of Science (JSPS). In 2011, he was assigned to the Graduate School of Humanities and Social Sciences at Saitama University as an Assistant Professor, and in 2013, he was promoted to tenured Associate Professor. His primary research interests include dollarization, microfinance, and governance issues in developing countries.



Dr. Chiv Ratha, an Executive Vice Chancellor & PUCSR Board Member, is an experienced leader with a strong background in both the public and private sectors. He has served in various significant roles, including Deputy Secretary-General of the Cambodia National Youth Council and Deputy Director General of Youth at the Ministry of Education, Youth, and Sports. With over two decades of expertise in youth development, strategic leadership, policy development, and legislative drafting, Dr. Chiv has played a vital role in shaping national programs and policies. Additionally, he has a solid academic background, having served as Dean of the Faculty of Tourism and Hospitality Management and the Faculty of Business Administration at Pannasastra University of Cambodia. He holds a Ph.D. in Leadership, an MBA from Monash University, and a Bachelor of Pharmacy. Dr. Chiv is also actively involved in part-time lecturing and has diverse skills in leadership, education, event planning, customer service, and stakeholder collaboration.

SPEAKERS' BIOS



Dr. Rada Khoy, an Economist at UNDP Cambodia, holds a Ph.D. in Agriculture and Resource Economics from Japan. With extensive experience in economic and social development across UN agencies, INGOs, and research organizations, Rada advises UNDP Cambodia on policy, economic research, diagnostics and thought leadership, and development finance as an accelerator for development; and provides technical advice to national counterparts and other partners on sustainable and inclusive economic policies in support of the SDGs and the national development priorities. He also contributes to the UNDP's work across the Asia-Pacific region, including collaboration with the UNDP regional economist network and Global Policy Network.



Maria C. Lo Bue is an Associate Professor in the Department of Economics, Business, Mathematics and Statistics at the University of Trieste. Her research focuses on development economics, particularly inequality, social mobility, and women's economic empowerment. She received her PhD from the University of Göttingen (Germany) in 2015 and previously held positions at the Universities of Verona, Göttingen, and Bari, as well as at UNU-WIDER (Helsinki). She has also consulted for several international organisations, including UN Women, UN-DESA, ODI, and EBRD, and for the Government of Indonesia's National Team for the Acceleration of Poverty Reduction.

DURING THE CONFERENCE

AWARENESS

We strive to ensure that the SAERD25 is a place of respectful intellectual exchange, free of discrimination and violations of attendees' personal boundaries.

If you feel that the organizers or individual participants have failed to meet these principles, requiring rapid action, please report this to the reception desk. You can ask to speak (if desired anonymously, by telephone) to one of the SAERD25 organizers, Kosal Nith or Sattwick Dey Biswas. In non-urgent cases you can also inform the organisers of issues and make suggestions by writing to saerdconf@gmail.com.

Credible complaints against participants can lead to their exclusion from the current or future conferences.